



DIAMOND CLUB 99 OF EKITI

MOTTO: UNITED WE STAND



CONSTITUTION

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THE CONSTITUTION OF DIAMOND CLUB 99 OF EKITI

Whereassome Ekitielite having realized the need to bring the Ekiti intellectuals under one umbrella in order to harmonize the articulation of Ekiti people Opinions on important national issues and to promote the welfare of Ekiti people, the Progress and unity of Ekiti land, came together on the 25th day of November, 1999 to agree and resolved among themselves to form an association to be known, called and registered as "DIAMOND CLUB 99 OF EKITI" Therefore the constitution was enacted and hereby reviewed in 2013 and amended in 2023 as follows:

1. MOTTO:

UNITED WE STAND

2. VISION:

To provide quality leadership towards the cultural, economic, social and political development of Ekitiland and her people.

3. MISSION:

The Club shall promote and uphold the highest standards of our values, culture, economic development, political aspirations and social well-being of our Members and Ekiti people.

4. EMBLEM:

Hand Inside Diamond Shape

5. AIMS AND OBJECTIVES:

- i. To cater for the interest and welfare of its members
- ii. To promote the cultural, economic, political and social progress of Ekiti people as well as unity and progress of Ekiti land.
- iii. To encourage, promote and foster co-operation, friendship and understanding within the club and other Ekiti organizations.

- iv. To encourage consultation and dialogue as means of harmonizing divergent Opinions on issues affecting Ekiti land
- v. To encourage and support members to achieve higher and sustainable Personal economic goals.
- vi. To encourage members to assist their ekiti people especially younger people to aspire, pursue and achieve higher and sustainable economic and social goals.
- vii. To encourage highly placed members and Ekiti indigenes in positions of Influence and authority to mentor young Ekiti sons and daughters.

6. THE CLUB YEAR:

Shall run from January to December of each year

7. MEMBERSHIP:

- i. Shall be open to eligible Ekiti Men of unquestionable character and with a reasonable economic, educational and social background
- ii. Every member shall be entitled to records of proceedings
- iii. Be at liberty to host a meeting
- iv. Be at liberty to attend a meeting

8. LOSS OF MEMBERSHIP:

Member shall lose his membership if He:

- i. Shall not meet the financial obligation(s) for a continuous period of three Months and after the expiration of another period of three months from the date of a written notice of default thereof.
- ii. Shall conduct himself in a manner derogatory or scandalous to the club Whereby two-third (to the lower whole number) majority of members present and Voting in a well constituted general/emergency meeting shall vote in a favor of his expulsion from the club and shall not attend

the monthly General/Emergency Meeting of the Club of a continuous period of one year

9. ADMISSION OF MEMBERS:

- i. An intending member shall apply for admission to membership and by obtaining an Application form for N10,000 non-refundable.
- ii. A completed application form shall be referred to Executive Members of the Club
- iii. An admitted member shall be issued a letter of acceptance detailing the requirement of the club requirements.
- iv. The intending member shall within one (1) months submit a letter of acceptance of offer.
- v. Upon satisfaction of admission requirements such intending member(s) shall be Inducted into membership and issued a membership number.

10. BRANCHES:

- i. The general house may approve the establishment of a branch (es) of the club in Towns/cities/within and outside Nigeria
- ii. At least, five eligible applicants resident in such towns /cities shall apply for the Establishment of a branch of the club in writing and ;
- iii. The inauguration of the branch and induction of its members be performed by the President of DIAMOND CLUB 99 OF EKITI
- iv. The President shall be accompanied by members of the Executive, three Members of the General House and at least one trustee.

11. FUNCTIONS OF A NEW BRANCH:

A new branch shall Function for at least six months prior to its inauguration and the induction of its Members and finance its inauguration.

12. FINANCIAL OBLIGATIONS OF THE MEMBERS:

- i. The financial obligations of members shall be determined by the General House from time to time
- ii. Admission fees which shall be paid along with letter of acceptance of the offer of admission shall be 10,000 NGN as Stated in section 9 (i)
- iii. Annual subscription shall be 10,000 NGN
- iv. Other levies which the general house shall impose on every member as when the needs shall arise
- v. Members who have attained 70 years and above shall have the option of payment of half of their dues.

13. ORGANS OF THE CLUB:

The organs of the Club shall include.

- i. The General House
- ii. The Executive Committee
- iii. The board of trustees and Agba Egbe
- iv. Any other standing or Ad Hoc Committee that the General House shall approve.

14. FUNCTIONS OF THE ORGANS OF THE CLUB:

- i. **The General House:** The general house shall:
 - (a) Approve policies of the club
 - (b) Approve financial proposals and expenditures
 - (c) Elect officers of the club
 - (d) Set up standing Committees and appoint their Members, Chairmen and Secretaries
 - (e) Appoint internal and external Auditors and approve their fees if any
 - (f) Approve date for general/bye elections
- ii. **Executive Committee:**
 - (a) It shall be the duty of the Executive Committee to initiate policies and make recommendation to the General House for approval.

- (b) Take such steps as when necessary to ensure smooth running of the club
- (c) Scrutinize membership applications and make appropriate recommendations to the club

iii. The President - Who Shall:

- (a) Be the Chief Executive of the club
- (b) Preside over the meetings of the general house and the Executive Committee
- (c) Summon emergency meeting of the general house/the Executive Committee in his own capacity/as stipulated in this constitution
- (d) Exercise a casting vote when there is a tie in voting in a General/emergency meeting of the general house/the Executive Committee
- (e) Present and read an annual report on the activities of the club for each club year during his tenure of office.

Whose tenure of office shall be two (2) years term and a maximum of continuous two term.

iv. The Vice President - Who Shall:

- (a) Assist the President and take instruction from him
- (b) Perform the duties and enjoy the rights and privileges of the President in his absence and
- (c) Automatically assume the office of the President if it becomes vacant before expiration of the term of office pending elections at the end of the term of office

Whose tenure of office shall be two (2) years term and a maximum of continuous two terms.

v. The Secretary - Who Shall:

- (a) Take and circulate minutes of general/emergency and executive meetings.

- (b) Prepare the agenda for all meetings in consultation with the President/Vice in his absence
- (c) Keep custody of the common seal of the club and other properties of the club pertaining to his office
- (d) Handle all internal and external correspondences on behalf of the Club as appropriately authorized by the General House, Executive and President/his Vice in his absence.

Whose tenure of office shall be two (2) years term and a maximum of continuous two terms.

vi. The Assistant Secretary:

- (a) Assist the Secretary and take instructions from him
- (b) Perform the duties and enjoy the rights and privileges of the Secretary in his absence
- (c) Automatically assume the office of the Secretary if it becomes vacant before the expiration of the term of office pending election at the end of term of the office and be eligible to contest for the office.

Whose tenure of office shall be two (2) years term and a maximum of continuous two terms.

vii. The Treasurer- Who shall:

- (a) Issue receipts to the Financial Secretary for all monies received from him on behalf of the club
- (b) Pay same to the bank account of the club within forty eight (48) hours of receiving such monies from the Financial Secretary
- (c) Maintain an impress account the amount of which shall be determined by the General House, but shall not be above twenty thousand naira (N20,000.00)
- (d) Keep custody of all negotiable insurance policy(ies) and

- other properties of the club, such as club registration certificate, bank cheque, including those pertaining to his office
- (e) Surrender official relevant documents to internal/external auditors on the written instruction of the General House for routine checks and auditing purpose
- (f) Provide information on the financial position of the club as and when required by the general house, the President/his Vice in his absence or the Executive Committee

Whose tenure of office shall be two (2) years term and a maximum of continuous two terms.

Viii. The Financial Secretary - Who shall:

- (a) Receive and issue receipts for the monies and cheques collected on behalf of the club during/outside meeting sessions of the club/the executive committee
- (b) Pay such monies to the treasurer/to the bank accounts of the Club within forty eight (48) hours
- (c) Keep proper books of accounts and prepare statements of income and expenditure there on at the end of each Club year as often as required by the General House
- (d) Reconcile the accounts of the Club with the banker (s) and brief appropriate organs of the Club as at when necessary/requested
- (e) Keep custody of all properties of the Club pertaining to his office.

Whose tenure of office shall be two (2) years term and a maximum of continuous two terms.

Ix. Assistant Financial Secretary - who shall:

- (a) Assist the Financial Secretary and take instructions from him
- (b) Perform the duties and enjoy the rights and privileges of the Financial Secretary in his absence
- (c) Automatically assume the office of the Financial Secretary if it becomes vacant before the expiration of the term of office
- (d) Be eligible to contest for that office.

Whose tenure of office shall be two (2) years term and a maximum of continuous two terms.

X. The Social/Welfare Secretary - Who Shall:

- (a) Organize all social activities of the Club present reports of such social activities
- (b) Take custody of all properties of the Club pertaining to his office.

Whose tenure of office shall be two (2) years term and a maximum of continuous two terms.

Xi. Public Relations Officer- Who Shall:

- (a) Send message or inform the Members about the meeting date and venue
- (b) Serve as Club image maker
- (c) Represent and defend the Club in all meeting both within and outside Nigeria
- (d) Work with the Club legal adviser in case of any legal issues.
- (e) Assist the Social/Welfare Secretary to take decision
- (f) Perform the duties and enjoy the rights and privileges of the Social/Welfare in his absence
- (g) Automatically assume the office of the Social/Welfare Secretary if it becomes vacant before the expiration of the terms of office

Whose tenure of office shall be two (2) years term and a maximum of continuous two terms.

Xii. Chef Whip- Who Shall:

- (a) Be the coordinator of any meeting
- (b) Monitoring the peace and smooth running of every meeting
- (c) Coordinate the serving of food and any other entertainment within the meeting
- (d) Recommend and discipline any erring members that need to be discipline during the meeting
- (e) Coordinate the movement of the Members during the meeting.

Whose tenure of office shall be two (2) years term and a maximum of continuous two terms.

Xiii. Legal Adviser- Who Shall:

- (a) Advise the Club on all legal issues involving its activities and corporate existence
- (b) In conjunction with the P R O, represent and speak for the Club on legal matters including litigation as well as bilateral and multilateral relations between the Club and other Organization
- (c) Serve as the Chairman of the legal committee of the Club if and when established
- (d) Whose appointment and termination shall be determine by general/emergency meeting of the Club

15. APPENDIX 'A'

Special Clause

- (a) THE INCOME AND PROPERTY OF DIAMOND CLUB 99 OF EKITI, whosoever derived shall be applied towards the promotion of the objects of the DIAMOND CLUB 99 OF EKITI, as set forth in this RULES AND REGULATION/CONSTITUTION and no portion thereof shall be paid or transferred directly or indirectly, by way of dividend, bonus or otherwise howsoever by way of profit to the members of the DIAMOND CLUB 99 OF EKITI,
- (b) PROVIDED that nothing herein shall prevent the payment in good faith of reasonable and proper remuneration to any officer or servant of the DIAMOND CLUB 99 OF EKITI, but council so that no member of the council of Management or Governing Body shall be appointed to any salaried office of the DIAMOND CLUB 99 OF EKITI, or any office of the DIAMOND CLUB 99 OF EKITI, paid by fees and that no remuneration or other benefits in kind or money shall be given by DIAMOND CLUB 99 OF EKITI, to any member of such council or governing body except on payment of out of pocket expenses or reasonable and proper rent premises

demise, or let to the DIAMOND CLUB 99 OF EKITI, provided that the provision last aforesaid shall not hold more than one hundredth part of the capital and such member shall not be bound to account for any share or profit he may receive in respect of any such payment.

- (c) In the event of winding up or dissolution of the DIAMOND CLUB 99 OF EKITI, their remains after the satisfaction of all its debt and liabilities, any property whatsoever the same shall not be paid or distributed among the members of the DIAMOND CLUB 99 OF EKITI.

16. PATRON/MATRON:

The Club shall have:

- i. Not less than five Patron/Matron, one whom at least, shall be a traditional leader in any town of Ekiti
- ii. Be individually known and addressed as “a Patron/Matron” and collectively as Board of Trustees

17. THE BOARD:

Function - The Board shall:

- i. Play an advisory role to the Club on important issues
- ii. Mediate in dispute(s) affecting the Club/its Members
- iii. Take over the assets and liabilities of the Club in the event of dissolution/liquidation
- iv. Dispose such assets and liabilities in accordance with paragraph of the special clause attached to this constitution as (Appendix A)

18. A TRUSTEE SHALL CEASE TO HOLD OFFICE IF HE/SHE SHALL:

- i. Voluntarily resign from office
- ii. Be removed by a two - thirds (2/3) (correct to the lower whole number) Majority-of Members present and voting in a well constituted General/emergency meeting of the Club
- iii. Be certified in- sane by a competent body/individual
- iv. Be officially declared/declare himself bankrupt

- V. Be convicted by court of competent jurisdiction in/outside Nigeria

- Vi. Reside outside Nigeria on a long/permanent basis

19. AUDITORS:

- i. The General House shall appoint internal auditors as at when due
- ii. The Auditor's report shall be submitted to the General House during a general/an Emergency meeting not later than one month from the date of appointment.
- iii. Request Auditors shall be appointed from qualified Members who is Not an Executive Member

20. BANKERS:

- i. The Club shall maintain current, savings and fixed accounts in any reputable Bank registered in Nigeria
- ii. The General House shall approve a banker(s) for the Club from a list recommended by the Executive Committee
- iii. Signatories to the account(s) shall include:
 - a. The President
 - b. The Secretary
 - c. The Treasurer
- iv. The withdrawal of money from the account(s) shall require
 - a. Approval of the General House
 - b. The signatory of any two of the three approved signatories

21. MEETINGS:

- i. The monthly general meeting shall hold on the last Sunday of each month within the Club year at 3 pm and venue approved by the General House
- ii. The Executive Committee shall meet monthly at a date and venue approved by the Committee or the President
- iii. An emergency meeting may be summoned where
 - a. A simple majority present in a well constituted general

meeting passes a Resolution in favor of summoning an emergency meeting

- b. The President shall be satisfied that there is a need for an emergency Meeting and shall there by determine the date, time, and venue thereof.
- c. Not less than seven Financial Members shall request in writing, for an emergency meeting, stating clearly the reason(s) for the request and
- d. Not less than four Members of the Executive shall request, in writing, for An emergency meeting of the executive committee, stating clearly the reason for the request or the president shall grant the request his own opinion there or not withstanding
- e. **Monthly Dues:** Monthly due of 1,000 NGN shall be compulsory paid on or before the monthly meeting

22. ANNUAL GENERAL MEETING:

- i. Hold on any convenient day in the month of December
- ii. Be host by the Club/designated Member

23. THE NATIONAL CLUB CONGRESS:

- i. Hold at least once in two years
- ii. The General House shall approve the venue, date and time
- iii. The agenda for congress shall be presented and approved in a General/Emergency Meeting proceeding the congress, but not later than two weeks before the congress
- vi. Lateness/Absenteeism to any of the above meetings shall attract a fine approved Periodically by the General House.

24. DISCIPLINE:

- i. The general House shall exercise disciplinary powers over any members of the Club for serious or minor offences including acts of commission/omission, negligence

/dereliction of duty, and absence from or lateness to meetings inters alia.

- ii. The General House shall set up/request the Executive Committee to set up Disciplinary Committee to look into alleged serious offences and make appropriate recommendations far the approval of the General House
- iii. Penalties for minor offences, including absenteeism and lateness shall be determined and reviewed annually by the General House
- iv. Penalties involving suspension/dismissal from the club shall be approved by two third (2/3) (correct to the lower whole member) majority of Financial Members present and voting in a well constituted General/Emergency Meeting of the Club

25. QUORUM:

- i. One quarter (1/4) (correct to the lower whole number) majority of Financial Members present and voting in a well constituted General/Emergency Meeting of the club
- ii. Executive Committee shall form the quorum for the monthly/Emergency Meetings of the Executive

26. PROTEM OFFICERS:

- i. If the President and his Vice or any Officer and his assistant are absent from the General/Emergency/Executive Committee meetings of the club, Members of that meeting present shall after quorum has been formed and the agreed time for Commencing the meeting expires by not less than twenty minutes, nominate a Protean Officer(s) to perform the functions of the absent(s) for that particular Meeting.
- ii. On such occasion(s) the Protean Officers) shall enjoy the rights and privileges of The absent Officer(s) pending their arrival
- iii. On arrival of the Officer, the Protean Officer shall brief him and cease to be a Protean Officer or

- iv. If absent, the Protean Officer shall brief the Officer before the next meeting.

27. LANGUAGE:

Meetings of the Club shall be conducted mainly in Yoruba/Ekiti dialect/English

28. MERIT AWARD:

- i. The Club shall give merit awards to deserving members in recognition of their continuous, unbroken membership /loyalty and service to the Club at intervals of five, ten, fifteen and 20 years.
- ii. The Club shall also give merit awards to deserving non-members who have contributed to the enhancement of the Club's objectives through their services to Ekiti land and her People
- iii. Recommendation (s) for merit award(s) and the reasons thereof shall be submitted to the General House by the Executive Committee for consideration and approval, not later than one month before the proposed award
- iv. A candidate for a merit award was or may not be member of DIAMOND CLUB 99 OF EKITI,

29. ENTITLEMENTS/MEMBERS WELFARE:

- i. A member is entitled to the benefits specified hereunder provided he is:
- ii. Up-to-date in his financial obligations to the Club
- iii. Committed to the Club's aims and Objectives and of good conduct and;
- iv. Records at least 80% attendance/participation in Club activities

30. ILL- HEALTH:

- i. Long Hospitalization: The Club shall send at least 2 official

delegates to visit the member with a purse of N20,000.

- ii. Without Hospitalization: The Club shall send at least 2 official delegates to visit the member in his/her house without a purse.

31. DEATH OF:

(a) Spouse of a member:

- i. Shall attract a donation approved by the house of not less than N50,000.00 (fifty thousand naira only)
- ii. In the case of multiple spouses, the death of only one Spouse shall be officially recognized by the Club
- iii. The Club shall participate in a wake - keep service in respect of the spouse of a member who dies and shall spend not less than N20,000.00 (twenty thousand naira only) thereon, excluding cash donations approved by the house.
- iv. Member of the club shall attend the burial of a spouse of a member as if he were a member and default thereof shall attract a fine of N5,000.00 (five thousand naira only)

(b) Father/Mother of a Member: The Club is to send an official delegation of at least 2 Members with a purse of N50,000.

(c) Father/Mother-in-law: The Club shall send an official delegation of at least 2 Members with a purse of N30,000.

(d) Child: The Club shall send a delegation of 3 members to assist the deceased family any where The burial takes place. In the case of burial at home, an official delegation of 2 Shall pay a condolence visit to the deceased Parents.

(e) In any other cases of death of relations of members: The President shall exercise discretion and shall encourage members to visit the bereaved Family

32. WEDDING/MARRIAGES:

(a) Weddings/Marriages of a Member(s):

- i. Introduction: The Club is to send two delegates without a purse
- ii. Marriage: It is compulsory for all members to attend all marriages of all members. The Club is to present a befitting gift worth N30,000. For marriages solemnized and the Club shall send a delegation of 3 Members with a befitting gift/cash worth N20,000.

(b) Wedding/Marriages of Member's Children:

The Club shall honour invitations for only Church solemnized Weddings and shall present a gift worth N20,000.

33. AWARDS BY OTHER BODIES & RECOGNITION BY COMMUNITIES.

- i. **Coronation:** The Club would send a delegation of 3 and present a gift worth N20,000.
- ii. **National Award/Honour:** The Club shall send a delegation of 2 and present a congratulatory letter.
- iii. **Community Awards/Chieftaincy:** The Club shall send A congratulatory letter and Members encouraged to attend the ceremony.

34. HOUSE WARMING/OFFICE DEDICATION:

The Club shall send a delegation of 3 members and present a gift worth N20,000 Members are encouraged to honor the invitation.

35. BIRTHDAY OF MEMBERS:

The Club shall send 3 official delegates and present a gift of N20,000 to Members celebrating 50,60,70,80,90 and 100 years above and members are encouraged to attend en mass.

36. INVITATION FROM OTHER CLUBS:

Paragraph 18 sub-section 4 shall include invitations from Clubs and associations affiliated to the apex Ekiti organization promoted or sponsored/supported by the Club shall be honored

with a purse of N10,000.

37. NAMING CEREMONY:

The Club shall send 3 official delegates with a purse of N20,000. Members are encouraged to attend en mass.

38. RETIREMENT BENEFITS:

- i. A Member shall give notice of voluntary retirement from the Club not less than three months prior to the actual date of retirement
- ii. Benefits shall be based on
 - (a) Position(s) held or service rendered and
 - (b) Financial standing
 - (c) Benefits shall include
- i. A gift and a sendoff party shall be held within six months of the voluntary retirement of a member from the Club
- (d) The General House shall approve all retirement benefits on the recommendation of the Executive Committee

39. DEATH OF A MEMBER:

If a Member Dies:

- i. The President shall summon an Emergency General Meeting for information and briefing
- ii. The Club shall put a full page obituary announcement in the newspaper and bear expenses of conveying the corpse home and purchase the casket
- iii. Attendance to wake keep and burial service shall be mandatory for all members
- iv. A defaulter shall pay a fine of N5,000.00 (Five Thousand Naira only) in respect of burial. Exemption shall be granted only by the General House

40. WELFARE FUND:

- i. The Club shall Operate a welfare fund to be administered

- by the Executive Committee for the purposes of meeting Club obligation to members as contained in this constitution.
- ii. Every Member shall subscribe the sum of N5,000 to the fund annually.
- iii. The Executive shall cause to be transferred to this fund any surplus from the annual general subscription of members at the end of every financial year.

41. DISSOLUTION:

- I. Any motion for the dissolution of the Club shall be delivered to the General House/the President The Vice, in his absence at least one month before the debate on the proposed dissolution
- ii. For a motion for the dissolution of the Club to be valid for debate, it shall be Signed by one third (1/3) (correct to the lower whole number) of the financial Members present and voting in a well constituted monthly/emergency meeting Shall vote in favour of dissolving the Club, the General House shall then
 - (a) Inform the Board of Trustees in writing that the General House has voted in Favor of dissolving the Club and
 - (b) There upon the Board shall
 - i. Request the President/his Vice in his absence, to convene an Emergency General Meeting of not later than two months from the date that the Board Received the information
 - ii. Appoint auditors to prepare final audited accounts of the Club
 - iii. Request all officers of the Executive Committee to surrender all properties of the Club in their custody to the Board
 - iv. The Emergency Meeting shall:
 - a. Approve the audited accounts
 - b. Pass a resolution by acclamation that then Club be dissolved without any further debate

- v. Thereafter, the Board shall:
 - a. Take over the assets and liabilities of the Club arid
 - b. Dispose them in accordance with paragraph four of the special clause attached to the constitution as (APPENDIX A)

42. ENTITLEMENT BENEFITS:

Only Member who is contributing financially shall benefit from the above entitlement, any debt or a financial default shall be removed from such benefits before handling over to the beneficiary Member.

The Constitutions Drafting Committee are;

DIAMOND OMOLAYO KEHINDE

Sign. _____

DIAMOND OGUNTUASE FRANCIS S.

Sign. _____

DIAMOND OMOTOSHO OLAGOKE

Sign. _____

DIAMOND OGUNTUASE KAZEEM O.

Sign. _____